

Interventions Cheat Sheet for Notes

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EMDR

Phase 1: History and Treatment Planning: The therapist and client discuss the reasons for therapy, review history, and develop a plan, identifying specific targets for processing.

Phase 2: Preparation: The therapist explains the process, sets expectations, and teaches coping techniques, such as "safe place" exercises, to help the client manage emotional distress.

Phase 3: Assessment: The client identifies a specific target memory, including the negative image, belief, emotions, and physical sensations.

Phase 4: Desensitization: The client focuses on the memory while engaging in bilateral stimulation (eye movements, taps, or tones) to reduce the emotional disturbance.

Phase 5: Installation: The focus shifts to strengthening a positive, adaptive belief to replace the negative one identified during assessment.

Phase 6: Body Scan: The client checks for any remaining physical tension when focusing on the original memory, aiming for a neutral physical response.

Phase 7: Closure: The session concludes by returning the client to a state of balance and ensuring they feel stable.

Phase 8: Reevaluation: The next session begins with an assessment of progress to determine if the trauma has been fully processed or if further work is needed.

CBT (Cognitive Behavioral Therapy)

- Psychoeducation
- Cognitive restructuring - Identifying and challenging unhelpful thinking or cognitive distortions
 - Socratic questioning - guides clients toward more accurate and balanced thinking; Technique for examining, challenging, and changing irrational thoughts
 - Clarifying Questions - Gain a deeper understanding of the client's thoughts and experiences
 - Can you tell me more about that?
 - What exactly do you mean when you say...?
 - Probing Assumptions - Challenge the validity and rationality of the client's beliefs
 - What evidence do you have to support that belief?
 - How might someone else view this situation differently?
 - Exploring Implications - Examine the broader consequences of the client's thought patterns
 - If that's true, what would the long-term effects be?
 - How might this belief influence your decisions and actions?

- ABC Model - A. Adversity or activating event; B. Your beliefs about the event. It involves both obvious and underlying thoughts about situations, yourself, and others.; C. Consequences, which includes your behavioral or emotional response.
 - It's assumed that B links A and C. Additionally, B is considered to be the most important component. That's because CBT focuses on changing beliefs (B) in order to create more positive consequences (C).
- Chain analysis
 - Vulnerability/Sensitivity: what set me up?
 - Trigger: what set me off?
 - Feelings: what emotions did I feel?
 - Physical sensations: what happened in my body?
 - Thoughts/Images: what went through my mind?
 - Behaviour/Actions: what did I do?
 - Short-term consequences: what changed in the short-term?
 - Long-term consequences: what happened in the long-term?
 - Conclusions: what have I learned? How do my reactions now make more sense to me?
- Reframing (therapist giving the client a different and usually more positive way to look at a situation)
- Affirmations (the client is encouraged to give themselves daily messages that serve to motivate them and boost their self-esteem)
- Identifying emotions
- Thought stopping
- Cognitive defusion
- Guided discovery - The therapist will acquaint themselves with the client's viewpoint. Then they'll ask questions designed to challenge your beliefs and broaden your thinking.
- Downward arrow technique (method used to uncover deep-seated, often unconscious, core beliefs that drive negative emotions and behaviors. By repeatedly asking "What does this mean about me?" or "What is the worst that could happen?" to surface-level automatic thoughts, the technique moves down from intermediate beliefs to the root core beliefs)
- Behavioral activation and activity scheduling
- Exposure and response prevention (ERP)
- Exposure therapy - creating an exposure hierarchy, imaginal exposure, in vivo exposure
- Relaxation training and stress reduction - progressive muscle relaxation (PMR), guided imagery, deep breathing
- Mindfulness
- Journaling and thought records
- Self-monitoring (clients keep track of their behavior)
- Problem solving
- Role-playing
- Successive approximation (scaffolding)
- Assigning homework and reviewing homework
- Social skills training - assertiveness training, positive communication skills training

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) for Children:

- **Cognitive Restructuring**
 - Identify negative thoughts (kid-friendly language: ANTs: Automatic Negative Thoughts)
 - Challenge distorted thinking (e.g., all-or-nothing, catastrophizing)
 - Generate alternative, more helpful thoughts
 - Practice new thought patterns using repetition, visual aids, and real-life examples
- **Psychoeducation**
 - Teaching the CBT model (thoughts–feelings–behaviors connection)
 - Normalizing emotions and reactions
- **Attention Shifting**
 - Redirecting focus away from distressing thoughts.
 - Training flexible attention (e.g., “brain spotlight,” 5 senses grounding, attention games)
- **Self-Monitoring**
 - Tracking thoughts, feelings, behaviors (emotion thermometers, mood charts, simple logs)
- **Behavioral techniques**
 - Shaping, prompting, and reinforcing adaptive behaviors
- **Exposure Therapy**
 - Creating fear ladders
 - Practicing approach behaviors with support and coping tools
- **Behavioral Activation**
 - Increasing engagement in positive, meaningful, and mastery-building activities
 - Scheduling pleasant activities
- **Positive Reinforcement**
 - Token economy (stickers, points, stars)
 - Specific praises
 - Clear reward systems tied to effort and skills use

Emotion Regulation and coping

- **Relaxation Techniques**
 - Deep breathing
 - Progressive muscle relaxation
 - Guided imagery
 - Mindfulness-based practices (adapted for kids)
- **Emotional recognition and expression**
 - Identifying emotions
 - Naming emotions

- Linking emotions to body sensations
- Safe expression of feelings

Skills Building

- **Problem-Solving Skills**
 - Identify the problem
 - Brainstorm solutions
 - Evaluate consequences
 - Choose and try a solution
 - Reflect on outcome
- **Skills Training**
 - Coping skills
 - Communication skills
 - Frustration tolerance
 - Self-regulation strategies
- **Social Skills Training**
 - Turn-taking
 - Assertive communication
 - Perspective-taking
 - Repairing mistakes

Acceptance and Commitment Therapy (ACT)

- Values clarification exercises.
 - Values card sort or domain exploration (relationships, work, health).
 - Distinguishing values from goals.
 - Identifying discrepancies between values and behavior.
- Cognitive defusion skills.
 - Identifying fusion with self-critical or catastrophic thoughts.
 - “I am having the thought that...” exercise.
 - Externalizing thoughts (labeling mental events).
 - Repeating distressing thoughts aloud to reduce believability.
- Present Moment Awareness
 - Brief grounding exercises (5-4-3-2-1, breath awareness).

- Mindful check-ins during session.
- Noticing internal vs. external experience.
- Body scan or sensory tracking.
- Acceptance (Increase willingness to experience internal states without avoidance.)
 - Psychoeducation on experiential avoidance and emotional suppression.
 - Guided acceptance exercise (“making space” for emotions).
 - Urge surfing for distress tolerance.
 - Normalization of unwanted thoughts and emotions as universal human experiences.
- Committed Action
 - Behavioral activation aligned with values.
 - SMART goal setting within values domain.
 - Identifying barriers to action.
 - Exposure framed as value-based movement.
 - Reviewing follow-through and reinforcing small wins.

Solution-focused/Narrative Therapy

- Externalizing conversations
- Identifying unique outcomes
- Problem deconstruction
- Therapeutic documentation—co creating materials with client to reinforce adaptive narratives

Key Psychodynamic Interventions

1. Clarification

The therapist helps the client articulate vague or confusing thoughts and feelings.

“When you say you feel ‘off,’ what does that feel like exactly?”

- **Goal: Increase awareness and emotional precision.**

2. Confrontation

Gently pointing out inconsistencies or avoidance.

“You say you want closeness, but you often cancel plans when someone gets close.”

- **Goal: Highlight defenses or patterns.**

3. Interpretation

Linking current behavior to unconscious motives or past experiences.

“I wonder if your reaction to criticism feels similar to how you felt with your father.”

- **Goal: Make unconscious dynamics conscious.**
- **Interpretations can focus on:**

Defenses

Transference

Repressed feelings

Repeating relational patterns

4. Working with Defense Mechanisms

- **Identifying strategies like:**

Denial

Projection

Intellectualization

Rationalization

Splitting

Humor (sometimes adaptive)

- **The therapist helps the client see:**

What the defense protects them from

The emotional cost of maintaining it

5. Exploring Transference

- **Transference = the client unconsciously projects feelings from past relationships onto the therapist.**

Example:

Client fears therapist will abandon them after a small scheduling change.

- **Therapist intervention:**

“I notice you seemed worried I might not come back next week. Has that feeling shown up in other relationships?”

This helps uncover core relational templates.

6. Countertransference Awareness

- **The therapist monitors their own emotional reactions to understand the client’s relational world.**

Example:

Therapist feels unusually criticized → may reflect client’s internalized critical parent dynamic.

7. Affect Focus

- **Encouraging deeper emotional experience rather than intellectual analysis.**

“Can we stay with that feeling for a moment?”

“Where do you feel that in your body?”

- **Goal: Emotional processing rather than cognitive explanation.**

8. Exploring Early Relationships

- **Looking at attachment figures and developmental experiences.**

Questions often include:

“What was it like growing up in your home?”

“How did your caregivers respond when you were upset?”

This reveals internalized relational patterns.

9. Identifying Repetition Compulsion

Noticing repeated relational or life patterns.

Choosing emotionally unavailable partners

Recreating familiar conflict dynamics

Therapist might say:

“This seems similar to what happened in your last three relationships.”

10. Working Through

A central psychodynamic process.

Repeatedly examining patterns over time in different contexts until deeper integration occurs.

Insight alone isn’t enough — it must be emotionally processed multiple times.

DBT-C

A. Mindfulness skills

1. Observe and describe: learn to notice thoughts, emotions, sensations without immediately reacting. Goal: reduce fusion and impulsivity.
2. Wise mind practice: differentiate Emotion Mind vs Reasonable Mind and access integration. Goal: improve decision making under emotional intensity.
3. What skills: observe, describe and participate. Goal: increase present moment awareness.
4. How skills: non judgmental, one mindfully. Goal: reduce shame and self criticism.
5. Grounding 5 4 3 2 1: Anchor to sensory input during overwhelm. 5 things you see, 4 you can touch, 3 you hear, 2 you smell, and 1 you taste. Goal: decrease dissociation and anxiety spikes.
6. Body scan and emotion naming: connect physical sensations with emotional states. Goal: increase interoceptive awareness.

B. Distress tolerance skills

1. TIPP: temperature, intense exercise, paced breathing, paired muscle relaxation. Goal: rapidly down regulate physiological arousal.
2. STOP: interrupt impulsive reaction cycles. Goal: create space before behaviour.

3. Radical acceptance: stop fighting reality that cannot be changed. Goal: reduce secondary suffering.
4. Pros and cons analysis: evaluate short and long term consequences of behaviors. Goal: reduce self destructive actions.
5. Urge surfing: ride out impulses without acting on them. Goal: build distress tolerance capacity.
6. Improve the moment: imaginary, meaning, relaxation, one thing at a time, encouragement. Goal: survive a crisis without worsening it.

C. Emotional regulation skills

1. Check the facts: evaluate whether emotional intensity matches reality. Goal: reduce cognitive distortions.
2. Opposite action: act opposite to emotion driven urges when emotion is unjustified. Goal: reshape behavioral patterns.
3. PLEASE skill: Physical illness, balanced eating, avoid substances, sleep and exercise. Goal: reduce biological vulnerability to mood swings.
4. Emotion tracking log: identify triggers and patterns. Goal: increase emotional literacy.
5. Build positive experience: Increase intentional rewarding activities. Goal: counter chronic emptiness or depression.

D. Interpersonal effectiveness skill

1. DEAR MAN: assert needs clearly while maintaining self respect. Goal: reduce passive or aggressive communication.
2. GIVE: maintain relationship effectiveness. Goal: increase warmth and connection.
3. FAST: maintain self respect in interactions. Goal: reduce resentment and people pleasing.
4. Boundary mapping: clarify limits and relational expectations. Goal: increase autonomy and emotional safety.

E. Behavioral chain analysis

- Steps:
 - Trigger
 - Vulnerabilities
 - Thoughts
 - Emotions
 - Behavior
 - Consequences

This helps identify where to insert new skills.

Terapia Conductual

- Plan de intervención conductual
- Modificación de la conducta
 - Entrenamiento de habilidades
 - Cambio en el entorno
 - Programa de contingencias específicas
 - Refuerzo
 - Positivo
 - Negativo
 - Intermitente
 - Economía de fichas
 - Extinción
 - Tiempo fuera
 - Castigo
 - Positivo
 - Negativo - Coste de respuesta
 - Contratos conductuales
 - Modelamiento - Aprendizaje por observación
 - Encadenamiento
 - Técnicas de exposición.
 - En vivo/imaginaria
 - Desensibilización Sistemática
 - Detención de pensamiento
 - Autoinstrucciones

Dialectical Behaviour Therapy (DBT)

Mindfulness

- Observing
- Mental Body Scan
- Internal vs External
- Describing your emotions
- Thought Defusion
- Mental Noting
- Mindful Breathing
- Wise Mind
- Negative Judgements
- Letting go of Judgements

Emotion Regulation

- Recognizing your Emotion
Being Effective (set goals and creating actionable steps to reach them)
- Emotions and Physical Vulnerability
- Emotions and Cognitive Vulnerability (examine distortions in your patterns of thinking and make adjustments)
- Self Validation
- Myths about Emotions
- Balancing Emotional Urges
- Problem Solving
- Mastery and Coping Ahead
- STOP - pausing when strong emotions come and regulating
- ABC PLEASE - building positive habits for emotional resilience

Distress Tolerance

- Cost Benefit Analysis
- Recognize Emotional Crisis
- Distracting Activities
- RESISTT Technique
- Grounding
- Willingness vs Willfulness
- Radical Acceptance
- Actions Based on Values
- TIPP - calming emotions with Temperature, Intense exercise, Paced breathing and Progressive muscle relaxation
- Half Smile
- ACCEPTS - quick distraction tools to steer your mind and body away from distress
- Urge Surfing

Interpersonal Effectiveness

- Communication Styles - identification
- Skills of Assertiveness
- Assertiveness Scripts and Interpersonal Rights
- Listening and Validation
- Barriers to Interpersonal Effectiveness
- Interpersonal boundaries
- Modulating Intensity
- Resistance and Conflict - effective communication
- DEAR MAN - communicating clearly and assertively
- FAST - being fair, not apologising, sticking to values and being honest
- GIVE - maintaining relationship through gentleness validation and an easy-manner tone